

Round 2 — “Everyone’s a Suspect”

10:00 PM – 11:00 PM

Scene: Everyone’s inside. The party is over. The host opens, then turns the players loose to talk to each other. Move, pair off, trade alibis and secrets in conversation. **Yes-and rule:** if someone asks you something not on your card, play along; make it up consistent with your character.

- **Your alibi:** *“Conference room. Tax strategy. With Gloria and Lorraine. I didn’t leave.”*
- **Share in conversation:**
 - Confirm Gloria’s alibi readily. Maybe too readily.
 - Mop your face with the pre-dampened handkerchief constantly. The audience should see wet patches.
 - If pressed about Gloria stepping out, hold the line — for now. *“She... went to the restroom. It was nothing.”* You’ll crack in Round 3.
- **Seek out:** Lorraine (panicked: *“Help me out here”*), nobody else.

Your reaction when Lorraine calls out the watch count (late round)

Late in the round, Lorraine will speak across the room — addressed to Gloria, but loud enough that you feel it land:

- Lorraine: *“Mrs. Reyes. That’s four times in the last ten minutes you’ve checked your watch. Are we keeping you?”*
- Gloria: *“Force of habit. PTA.”*
- **You:** Sweat visibly. Mop your face with the now-soaked handkerchief. Don’t speak.
- Lorraine continues, evenly: *“Gerald checked his watch four times too. He was watching hers.”*
- **You:** Don’t deny it. Don’t confirm it. Stare at the table. The handkerchief should be visibly wet.